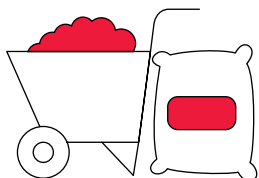


WHAT HE DID RIGHT

- 01 The group holds the top slot globally in aluminium rolling, is second in carbon black, cellulosic staple fibres and copper rods, while being third largest in cement
- 02 Under Kumar Mangalam Birla, the traditional businesses have become stronger, while the B2C segments have grown impressively
- 03 Growth has come from a combination of organic and inorganic opportunities, both in India and overseas
- 04 Birla is known to spot big opportunities and back them up with high-quality execution



BEST CEOs

**KUMAR
MANGALAM BIRLA**
BUSINESS ICON OF THE YEAR

EXPANDING THE EMPIRE

Kumar Mangalam Birla has built a diversified conglomerate, venturing into new areas even as he has transformed legacy businesses into industry leaders

BY **KRISHNA GOPALAN**

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IN THE THIRD WEEK of January, Kumar Mangalam Birla summarised the current global situation as uncertain, unpredictable, and unorthodox. “Importantly, we will be embracing an uncertain world, not wrestling with it,” he said in his annual note.

As Chairman of the \$65 billion Aditya Birla Group that has a presence across 41 countries, he must stay ahead of developments. The

group has a global presence across sectors and holds the top slot globally in aluminium rolling and second in carbon black, cellulosic staple fibres and copper rods and third in cement (excluding China). Besides, it has become more diversified in the three decades that Birla has helmed it, even as he has strengthened existing businesses.

In recognition of these efforts, Birla has been chosen as the **Business Icon of the Year** in the BT-PwC India’s Best CEOs list.

STRATEGIC HEFT

The Aditya Birla Group has a blend of traditional businesses with a focus on commodities and a strong business-to-consumer portfolio—an indication of the diverse opportunities India offers.

“The strengths of the traditional